

**UNIT
5**

**DIRECT AND
INDIRECT SPEECH**

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21 REPORTED SPEECH (ALL TYPES OF SENTENCES)

• Direct Speech

Direct speech involves quoting the exact words spoken by a person, enclosed in quotation marks. The speaker's exact words are replicated as they were originally spoken or written, making it clear what was said without any alterations.

Example:

- Tom said, "I am going to the market."

In direct speech, you often include a reporting verb (e.g., said, replied, asked) and use quotation marks to indicate the exact language used by the speaker.

• Indirect Speech (also known as Reported Speech)

Indirect speech involves paraphrasing what someone said without quoting them directly. This does not require quotation marks and often involves changes in verb tenses, pronouns, and other words to fit the context in which the speech is being reported. Indirect speech is used to summarize or explain someone else's words in a way that integrates smoothly with the surrounding narrative.

Example:

- Tom said that he was going to the market.

When transforming direct speech into indirect speech, several changes are necessary.

Steps to Convert Direct Speech to Indirect Speech

1. Remove the quotation marks.
2. Add "that" to connect the reporting clause and the reported speech if needed. (Check the type of sentence to place the conjunction correctly.)

• Placement of "that" depends on the type of sentence being reported:

1. Statements:

- Always place "that" after the reporting verb when converting statements to Indirect Speech.
- **Direct:** He said, "The project is due next week."
- **Indirect:** He said that the project was due the following week.

2. Questions (Yes/No):

- Do not use "that" in Yes/No questions. Instead, use if or whether to connect the clauses.
- **Direct:** She asked, "Do you like pizza?"
- **Indirect:** She asked if I liked pizza.

3. Questions (Wh-):

- Do not use "that" to connect Wh- questions. Use the Wh- word directly.
- **Direct:** He asked, "What are you doing this weekend?"
- **Indirect:** He asked what I was doing that weekend.

4. Commands and Requests:

- Do not use "that" in commands or requests. Use to + verb instead.
- **Direct:** She said, "Please send the report."
- **Indirect:** She asked me to send the report.

Examples

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
"We are moving to a new city," she said.	She said that they were moving to a new city.
"Did you see the movie?" he asked.	He asked if I had seen the movie.
"Why are you late?" she asked.	She asked why I was late.
"Bring your books tomorrow," he said.	He told me to bring my books the next day.

Rules for Adjusting Pronouns

1. First Person Pronouns (I, We, Me, Us):

- Change to match the subject of the reporting clause (the reporter).
- **Direct:** She said, "We are excited about the trip."
- **Indirect:** She said that they were excited about the trip.

2. Second Person Pronouns (You, Your):

- Change to match the listener or object of the reporting clause (the person being addressed).
- **Direct:** He said, "You need to finish this."
- **Indirect:** He said that I needed to finish this.

3. Third Person Pronouns (He, She, It, They, Them, His, Her):

- Generally, third-person pronouns do not change because they already refer to others.
- **Direct:** She said, "He can join us later."
- **Indirect:** She said that he could join them later.

Tense Changes in Indirect Speech

Change the tense of the verb if the reporting verb is in the past tense.

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech	Example
Present Simple	Past Simple	"I go to school," she said. → She said that she went to school.
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	"We are studying," he said. → He said that they were studying.
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	"I have lost my keys," she said. → She said that she had lost her keys.
Present Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I have been working," he said. → He said that he had been working.
Past Simple	Past Perfect	"They bought a new car," he said. → He said that they had bought a new car.
Past Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	"I was cooking dinner," he said. → He said that he had been cooking dinner.
Past Perfect	No Change	"I had seen the movie," she said. → She said that she had seen the movie.
Past Perfect Continuous	No Change	"I had been studying," he said. → He said that he had been studying.
Future Simple (will)	Would	"I will help you later," she said. → She said that she would help me later.

Change of Time/Place Words

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech
This	That
These	Those
Here	There
Now	Then
Today	That day
Tonight	That night
Tomorrow	The next day
Yesterday	The day before/ the previous day
Next week	The following week
Last week	The previous week
Ago	Before

Exercise: 1

Convert the direct speech into indirect speech. Write your answers in the space provided after "Indirect:". Assume that the reporting speech is in the past.

1. Direct:

- **Teacher:** "Has everyone completed the homework?"
- **Students:** "Yes, we have finished it."

Indirect: The teacher asked if everyone had completed the homework,
and the students replied that they had finished it.

2. Direct:

- **Ali:** "I will present my project on Thursday."

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Sara:** "Can I borrow your math book?"
- **Noor:** "Sure, you can take it now."

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Teacher:** "You need to improve your writing skills."
- **Hasan:** "I will work on that, sir."

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Umar:** "Did you see the cricket match yesterday?"
- **Kamal:** "No, I missed it."

Indirect: _____

Exercise: 2

Convert the following news announcements from direct to indirect speech as if you are reporting them to a friend.

1. Direct:

- **News Anchor:** "The school will remain closed tomorrow due to a national holiday."

Indirect: _____

2. Direct:

- **Weather Reporter:** "Tomorrow's temperature will reach up to 35 degrees Celsius."

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Health Official:** "A new health clinic will open next month in the north district."

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Sports Commentator:** "The national team won the championship last night."

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Financial Analyst:** "The stock market rose by three per cent this morning."

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **City Mayor:** "We will start the new housing project in early April."

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Local Journalist:** "The festival has been postponed to a later date due to unexpected weather conditions."

Indirect: _____

Exercise: 3

You were discussing past events with a friend. Convert these direct speech examples into indirect speech.

1. Direct:

- **Mother:** "We used to visit your grandparents every Friday."

Indirect: *Her mother told her that they used to visit her grandparents every Friday.*

2. Direct:

- **Friend:** "I lost my new phone at the mall yesterday."

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Sibling:** "I have decided to study abroad next year."

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Classmate:** "I got the highest score in our maths test!"

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Neighbour:** "We adopted a puppy last weekend."

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **Cousin:** "I will be visiting from Islamabad next month."

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Old Friend:** "We met at the summer camp three years ago, remember?"

Indirect: _____

Exercise: 4

Complete the sentences with say or tell (in the correct form). Use only one word each time.

1. Sarah said goodbye to me and left.
2. _____ us about your holiday. Did you have a nice time?
3. Don't just stand there! _____ something!
4. I wonder where Sofia is. She _____ she would be here at 8 o'clock.
5. Hasan _____ me that he was bored with his job.
6. The doctor _____ that I should rest for at least a week.
7. Gary couldn't help me. He _____ me to ask Hasan.
8. Don't _____ anybody what I _____. It's a secret just between us.
9. 'Did Sofia _____ you what happened?' 'No, she didn't _____ anything to me.'

Exercise: 5

The following sentences are direct speech:

- Don't wait for me if I'm late.
- Mind your own business.
- Please slow down!
- Can you open your bag, please?
- Don't worry, Sofia.
- Hurry up!
- Do you think you could give me a hand, Zain?

Now choose one of these to complete each of the sentences below. Use reported speech.

1. Zain was taking a long time to get ready, so I told him to hurry up.
2. Sarah was driving too fast, so I asked _____

3. Sofia was nervous about the situation. I told

4. I couldn't move the piano alone, so I

5. The security guard looked at me suspiciously and

6. The man started asking me personal questions, so I

7. I didn't want to delay Sofia, so I

Exercise: 6

Convert the following sentences from direct speech into indirect speech. Pay attention to changes in verb tenses, pronouns, and time expressions.

1. Direct: Ali and I said, "We go to the gym every day."

Indirect: *Ali and I said that we went to the gym every day.*

2. Direct: "They are reading a new book now," the students said.

Indirect: _____

3. Direct: Noor said, "I have finished my homework."

Indirect: _____

4. Direct: "He has been learning Spanish for two months," Umar's friend said.

Indirect: _____

5. Direct: Hassan's brother said, "You visited your grandparents last weekend."

Indirect: _____

6. Direct: "It was raining when I was playing football," Kamal said.

Indirect: _____

7. Direct: "They had seen the movie before he told them about it," Sarah said.

Indirect: _____

8. Direct: "We had been studying all night for the exam," Zara and her classmates said.

Indirect: _____

9. Direct: "She will travel to Lahore next week," Farah's sister said.

Indirect: _____

10. Direct: "You will be visiting the museum tomorrow," Bilal's mother told him.

Indirect: _____

11. Direct: "They will have completed the project by tomorrow," Ayesha's team leader said.

Indirect: _____

12. Direct: "Do you understand the lesson?" the teacher asked us.

Indirect: _____

13. Direct: "Didn't they go to the concert last night?" Sam asked.

Indirect: _____

14. Direct: "Will you help me with my homework?" Jamil asked his friend.

Indirect: _____

Imperative Sentences

1. Direct:

- **Mother said to the children:** "Clean your room before you go outside."

Indirect: *The mother told the children to clean their room before they went outside.*

2. Direct:

- **Coach said to the team:** "Give your best effort in today's game."

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Boss said to the staff:** "Please finish the reports by noon."

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Instructor said to the students:** "Turn off your mobile phones."

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Chef said to the assistant:** "Prepare the ingredients for the soup."

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **Father said to his son:** "Mow the lawn this afternoon."

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Teacher said to the class:** "Read chapter four for homework."

Indirect: _____

8. Direct:

- **Manager said to the employees:** "Log in to the meeting by 8 AM."

Indirect: _____

9. Direct:

- **Librarian said to the visitor:** "Return the books on time."

Indirect: _____

10. Direct:

- **Doctor said to the patient:** "Take these medications twice a day."

Indirect: _____

Exclamatory Sentences

1. Direct:

- **She said:** "What a beautiful painting this is!"

Indirect: *She exclaimed that it was a beautiful painting.* _____

2. Direct:

- **He exclaimed:** "I can't believe we won the match!"

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Child exclaimed:** "Wow, look how high that kite is flying!"

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Friend said:** "This is the best birthday party ever!"

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Mother exclaimed:** "That was an amazing performance!"

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **Tourist said:** "These views are breathtaking!"

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Athlete shouted:** "Yes! I finally broke the record!"

Indirect: _____

8. Direct:

- **Teacher said:** "Excellent job on the project, everyone!"

Indirect: _____

9. Direct:

- **CEO exclaimed:** "We've just reached an incredible milestone!"

Indirect: _____

10. Direct:

- **Driver yelled:** "Watch out for the ice on the road!"

Indirect: _____

Yes/No Questions

1. Direct:

- **Teacher asked the student:** "Have you completed your assignment?"

Indirect: _____

2. Direct:

- **Doctor asked the patient:** "Are you feeling better today?"

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Manager asked:** "Can you stay late tonight?"

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Mother asked:** "Did you eat all your dinner?"

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Coach asked:** "Will you join the team practice tomorrow?"

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **Friend asked:** "Are we still going to the movie tonight?"

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Sibling asked:** "Have you seen my charger?"

Indirect: _____

8. Direct:

- **Colleague asked:** "Do you have the meeting link?"

Indirect: _____

9. Direct:

- **Neighbour asked:** "Can you help me with the yard this weekend?"

Indirect: _____

10. Direct:

- **Partner asked:** "Should we order pizza for dinner?"

Indirect: _____

WH Questions

1. Direct:

- **Friend asked:** "Where are you going this weekend?"

Indirect: *The friend asked where I was going that weekend.*

2. Direct:

- **Colleague asked:** "Why are you leaving early today?"

Indirect: _____

3. Direct:

- **Teacher asked:** "What did you learn from this experiment?"

Indirect: _____

4. Direct:

- **Child asked:** "How do you make cookies?"

Indirect: _____

5. Direct:

- **Traveller asked:** "Which Road leads to the downtown area?"

Indirect: _____

6. Direct:

- **Employee asked:** "When is the next team meeting?"

Indirect: _____

7. Direct:

- **Interviewer asked:** "What skills can you bring to our company?"

Indirect: _____

8. Direct:

- **Buyer asked:** "How much does this painting cost?"

Indirect: _____

9. Direct:

- **Student asked:** "Who will be teaching the class next semester?"

Indirect: _____

10. Direct:

- **Guest asked:** "Why did the event get cancelled?"

Indirect: _____
